The mailbox year

The government tells you almost everything by letter, on a calendar nobody explains. Here is 2027, month by month: what arrives, what's due, and the page that explains it. A ☐ box means there's something to do.

January

LETTERS AND FORMS

- ☐ SSA-1099 for your taxes: SSA mails it January 3–24 · **p. 14**
- ☐ First payment with the 3.6% raise (paid on the 3rd? it came Dec 31, 2026) · **p. 9**
- ☐ Jan 1–Mar 31: switch Medicare Advantage plans once; sign up for missed Part B · **p. 20**

February

TAX FORMS

- ☐ Feb 1: pension and IRA 1099-R forms due to you · **p. 31**
- ☐ Lost SSA-1099? Copies online from Feb 1 · **p. 14**

March

LAST CALL

- ☐ Mar 31: Medicare Advantage switch and Part B sign-up windows close · **p. 20**

April

TAXES

- ☐ Apr 15: 2026 returns due. Free help for 60+ · **p. 31**
- ☐ Apr 1: first traditional-IRA withdrawal, if you turned 73 in 2026 and haven't taken it (2027's is still due Dec 31) · **p. 30**

May–Aug

QUIET MONTHS

- ☐ Medicare Summary Notice: every 6 months, if you had services (Original Medicare)

September

PLAN LETTERS

- [x] By Sept 30: your plan's Annual Notice of Change. Read it · **p. 19**
- [ ] Late Sept: the Medicare & You handbook arrives · **p. 20**

October

CHANGES OPEN

- [x] Oct 15: Open Enrollment begins (to Dec 7) · **p. 20**
- [ ] The next raise is announced (in 2026: October 14) · **p. 9**

November

NOTICES

- [ ] COLA notice online in my Social Security · **p. 10**
- [ ] Income (IRMAA) notices for next year's premium · **p. 18**

December

DEADLINES

- [x] Dec 7: Open Enrollment ends · **p. 20**
- [ ] COLA letter by mail · **p. 10**
- [x] Dec 31: this year's IRA withdrawal (ask your IRA company for its cutoff) · **p. 30**
- [ ] Dec 30: January 2028's SSI arrives early (Dec 31 is the New Year holiday) · **p. 11**

Any time

FROM SSA

- [ ] A letter about a higher Medicare premium because of income: SSA's page says “Any time” · **p. 18**
- [ ] Your birthday month: check your license renewal date · **p. 33**

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When a number changes, we send you the page

CMS usually announces the next year's Medicare premiums in November, and rules move during the year. Register your copy and we'll send each corrected page by email, free. In October we'll tell you when **The Large Print 2028** is ready.

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